Lesson notes · for you

When AI gets it wrong

AI · Level 1 · Lesson 4

Time
26 min

Materials
A notebook page for your “AI mistake of the week”; A pen; A phone you can use (yours or a family member’s), if you have one

Learning goals

- Tell a false alarm from a miss.
- Explain that people choose which mistake matters more, and that gaps in the data cause mistakes.
- Check, ask a person and report when AI gets it wrong.

Activity: Be the filter

1. Warm-up (3 min): Each person shares one time an app got something wrong: a translation, a suggestion, a message in the wrong folder. Was it a false alarm or a miss?
2. Write (5 min): Together, write 10 short messages on slips of paper: 6 real ones (homework, a match moved, a family message) and 4 scams (a prize, free data, an urgent request for a PIN). Mark the answer on the back. Leave out real names and numbers.
3. Filter (8 min): Shuffle the slips. One person is the filter and calls each message “spam” or “safe” without seeing the back. The others check and count false alarms (real messages called spam) and misses (scams called safe).
4. Move the line (6 min): Play twice more with a new filter. First be very strict: call anything slightly odd “spam”. Then be very relaxed: call only obvious scams “spam”. Compare the counts: what happens to false alarms and misses?
5. Decide (4 min): Agree which mistake matters more for school messages, and why. Then say what you would do if a real school message went to spam: check, ask, report.

You need 10 slips of paper and a pen. Write the answer (real or scam) on the back of each slip before you start, and use made-up names and numbers only.

Discussion

- For a school message filter, which mistake is worse: a false alarm or a miss?
- Whose voices or languages might an AI tool near you know least?
- Have you ever reported a mistake to an app? What happened?

Check yourself

- Give one example of a false alarm and one of a miss.

Try it this week
This week, catch one AI mistake: a wrong suggestion, a bad translation or a message in the wrong folder. Write down whether it was a false alarm or a miss, and what might have caused it.

Worksheet

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **For a smoke alarm, which mistake is worse?**

◯ Missing a real fire ◯ A false alarm from cooking steam ◯ Both are exactly as bad

2 **The computer decides by itself which mistake matters more.**

◯ True ◯ False

3 **Which of these are misses? Choose all that are.**

☐ A scam lands in your inbox with no warning
☐ Your friend's message is sent to spam
☐ A smoke alarm stays quiet during a real fire
☐ A smoke alarm beeps at cooking steam
☐ A spell-checker lets a misspelt word through

4 **Match each mistake to its most likely cause.**

After an update, many real school messages go to spam	It was set to go off easily, on purpose
A translator mixes up words in your grandmother's language	Dim light changed the numbers
Face unlock fails in a dark room	Little of that language in its examples
A smoke alarm beeps whenever someone fries eggs	The line was moved too low

✎ **Think of an AI mistake you have seen. Was it a false alarm or a miss, and who could it harm?**